

The Operational Gaps Audit & Fix-It Guide

Five places small businesses quietly lose time, money, and control. Find your gaps, then fix your first one before you even finish reading this.

HOW TO USE THIS

Check every statement that's true for your business right now. Each gap comes with a Quick Fix you can start today, no tools to buy, no help required. Add up your checks and turn to page 3 for what your score means.

1 The Onboarding Gap

- ☐ Every new client or customer gets brought on a little differently, depending on your mood or memory that week
- ☐ You've forgotten a step with a new client at least once in the last three months
- ☐ Bringing someone new on board lives in your head, not in a document or a tool

QUICK FIX

Write down the exact steps you took with your last three new clients, side by side. Whatever shows up all three times is your real process. Turn just those steps into a one-page checklist today.

2 The Capacity Gap

- ☐ You don't have a real number for how many clients or orders you can handle well
- ☐ You've said yes to something you didn't have room for in the last month
- ☐ Quality has slipped at least once because you took on too much at the same time

QUICK FIX

Pick a number right now, even if it feels arbitrary. That's your cap until you have real data to refine it. A rough limit you hold yourself to beats no limit, every time.

Gaps, Continued

3 The Time Gap

- ☐ If you took a week off with no phone, something in the business would break
- ☐ You're doing tasks today that you were also doing this exact same way a year ago
- ☐ You can't remember the last time you worked ON the business instead of IN it

QUICK FIX

For one week, jot down every task that only you can do. Everything not on that list by Friday is your first candidate to hand off, template, or automate.

4 The Money Gap

- ☐ You couldn't say what your profit margin is right now without digging
- ☐ Invoicing, payments, or tracking still happens manually or inconsistently
- ☐ You've been paid late, or missed billing someone, in the last three months

QUICK FIX

Set one recurring 15-minute money check, same day, same time, every week. What came in, what's owed, what's overdue. That single habit catches most billing gaps before they cost you.

5 The Follow-Up Gap

- ☐ Leads or past customers go quiet and nothing happens to bring them back
- ☐ You rely on remembering to follow up rather than a system that does it for you
- ☐ You've lost a sale or a client simply because no one followed up in time

QUICK FIX

Build a short list of every lead or past client who's gone quiet. Send one honest, no-pressure check-in message this week. That list and that message are the start of your whole follow-up system.

What Your Score Means

Count every box you checked across all five gaps. Fifteen statements total.

Add up your checks. **0 to 4** checked, **5 to 9** checked, or **10 to 15** checked. Find your range below.

0 to 4

SOLID GROUND

Your foundation is holding. Use the Quick Fixes on the gaps you did check before they turn into bigger problems as you grow.

5 to 9

SLIPPING

You're not disorganized, you're under-systemized. The business has outgrown a few of the ways you're still running it. Start with the Quick Fix for your worst gap this week.

10 to 15

STUCK

You are the single point of failure in almost everything you've built. That's not a character flaw, it's a sign the business grew faster than its infrastructure. The worksheet on the next page is your starting point.

Your business isn't broken. It just outgrew the version of you that started it.

Build Your First Fix

Pick your worst gap from pages 1 and 2. Fill this in before you close the tab. A plan you write down is a plan you actually do.

THE GAP COSTING ME THE MOST RIGHT NOW

WHAT IT'S ACTUALLY COSTING ME

Time, money, missed clients, your own sanity, be specific

THE QUICK FIX I'M STARTING THIS WEEK

HOW I'LL KNOW IT WORKED

One measurable sign, a number, a feeling, a Tuesday that goes differently

IF YOU WANT HELP GOING FURTHER

You don't have to fix the rest alone.

Book a free Discovery Call to walk through your results together, or ask about The Fix One Thing Sprint, a live three-week cohort where we build one full system with you, start to finish.

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